



Department of Computer Science & Engineering (IoT & Cybersecurity with BCT)
Academic Year: 2024 - 2025

PBC Business Proposal Outline

CRAVE – Homemade Comfort, Delivered Fresh



Prepared for: Business Proposal Presentation

Date of Submission: 11.04.2025



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A Business Proposal on:

CRAVE – Homemade Comfort, Delivered Fresh

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Certificate

Department of Computer Science & Engineering (I.O.T. & Cybersecurity with BCT)

This is to certify that following students of B.Tech Semester VI from Department of Computer Science & Engineering (ICB) have successfully completed the Business proposal presentation under the guidance of Prof. Shirley Mathew during the academic year 2024-25.

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Executive Summary:

- **Business Name and Concept:**

Crave is a digital platform redefining the traditional meal delivery ecosystem by connecting customers with home chefs—predominantly housewives—who offer fresh, homemade meals. Unlike conventional tiffin or dabbawala systems, Crave empowers chefs to share their curated daily menus in advance, giving customers the freedom to choose meals based on taste, budget, and preference. The platform manages logistics and delivery, offering seamless, same-city food fulfillment with a personal touch.

- **Mission Statement:**

To serve authentic, homemade meals with heart while empowering home chefs—especially women—with independence, income, and identity.

- **Vision Statement:**

Our vision is to become the go-to destination for nutritious, personalized home-cooked meals, providing a platform where customers can easily access healthy, delicious options tailored to their needs. We aim to build a thriving community of empowered home chefs, offering them flexibility, fair income, and the opportunity to showcase their talents. At the same time, we want to create a space where food lovers can discover new flavors, enjoy trustworthy meals, and engage with chefs in a meaningful way, making home-cooked food more accessible and enjoyable for all.

- **Product/Service Offering:**

The platform will feature a user-friendly mobile and web app designed to connect chefs with customers seamlessly. It will provide daily updated meal menus from a diverse range of home chefs, allowing customers to choose from a variety of healthy and personalized options. The app will include personalized meal selection and detailed chef profiles to help customers make informed decisions. A secure payment gateway will be integrated to ensure smooth and safe transactions. The platform will also handle end-to-end logistics and delivery fulfillment, ensuring reliable service. To maintain accountability and foster continuous improvement, ratings, reviews, and feedback systems will be incorporated. Additionally, optional features such as chef badges, favorite lists, and curated collections will enhance the user experience and help build a strong sense of community.

- **Target Market:**

The platform targets a wide range of users, including working professionals who are looking for healthy and convenient meal options to fit into their busy schedules. It also caters to students and young adults living away from home, who often crave homemade meals but lack the time or resources to cook. Senior citizens and homemakers with limited access to fresh cooking will find a convenient solution for nutritious meals delivered to their doorstep. Additionally, the platform offers home chefs, especially housewives, the opportunity to earn flexible work-from-home income by sharing their culinary skills with a broader audience, providing them with a chance to showcase their talents while maintaining a balanced lifestyle.



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- **Competitive Advantage:**

The platform operates on a chef-first model, giving home cooks the flexibility to take time off by simply not listing their menus. It ensures meal transparency, allowing customers to view meal details, prices, and ratings before ordering. Trust is built through community feedback and local sourcing of ingredients. Scalable delivery logistics are provided, relieving chefs from handling deliveries while ensuring reliable service. The fair income model offers chefs daily earnings with no complex commitments, creating a flexible and sustainable system for both chefs and customers.

- **Financial Overview:**

The platform generates revenue through several streams, including a commission from chefs for each successful order and a platform convenience fee charged to customers. Additional revenue is generated through featured chef promotions or premium listings, allowing chefs to gain greater visibility. In the future, a subscription model will be introduced, offering customers curated meal plans or priority access to popular chefs. The initial investment will be used to support key areas such as technology development, chef onboarding, marketing efforts, and integration of delivery logistics. To maintain cost efficiency, the platform will operate with a lean business model, utilizing technology and local logistics to streamline operations and minimize overhead.

Mandatory Sections:

Problem Statement

- **Purpose:**

Crave reimagines how people access everyday meals by empowering home-based chefs—especially housewives to share their culinary talent. It addresses the need for accessible, hygienic, and emotionally fulfilling homemade food in urban life. Many individuals, including working professionals, students, and the elderly, struggle with maintaining a nutritious diet away from home. Crave bridges this gap by providing a platform where chefs can showcase their meals, set their own menus, and earn a fair income. It's not just a food delivery service; it's a purpose-driven community that nourishes both body and soul while supporting micro-entrepreneurship.

- **Market Gaps / Customer Pain Points:**

Urban dwellers often face significant challenges when it comes to accessing affordable, healthy, and homemade food. With the fast-paced lifestyle in cities, many individuals rely heavily on restaurant takeout or processed convenience foods, which are often expensive, nutritionally imbalanced, and unsustainable in the long run. Traditional tiffin or dabbawala services, while offering home-style meals, tend to lack variety and transparency. Customers are typically unaware of who is cooking their food, what ingredients are being used, or the hygiene practices being followed during preparation. Moreover, these services rarely provide platforms for users to select specific meals or customize their dietary preferences, and there is generally no system in place for viewing chef ratings or feedback from other users, which limits customer choice and confidence.

- **Current Solutions:**

Restaurants and cloud kitchens are often expensive, serving food that can be unhealthy and lacking a personal touch, making them less appealing for those seeking affordable and home-cooked



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alternatives. Traditional tiffin services, while providing home-style meals, come with their own set of issues, such as lack of customization, inconsistent quality, and rigid menus that don't cater to the diverse tastes or dietary needs of customers. Food delivery apps, on the other hand, tend to prioritize commercial kitchens over home-based chefs, limiting the variety and authenticity of home-cooked options available to consumers. Local word-of-mouth chef groups, while providing a sense of community, are typically unorganized, making them difficult to scale or access for a broader audience. These limitations create a gap in the market that a more structured, flexible platform can address.

- Why is solving this problem important to the target market?

This issue goes beyond convenience—it affects quality of life, gender empowerment, and healthy urban living. For customers, particularly in Tier-1 and Tier-2 cities, time is limited, and meal options are often either unhealthy fast food, expensive restaurant meals, or bland tiffin services. Customers seek healthy, convenient, and transparent meals that reflect their values and provide a sense of connection. Crave meets this need by offering customizable, home-cooked meals prepared by real people. For home chefs, especially housewives, this problem represents an untapped opportunity. Many women possess cooking skills but lack flexible, respectful platforms to share their talent. Crave empowers these chefs by offering autonomy, flexibility, and fair compensation, allowing them to balance family responsibilities while earning a dignified income.

Business Idea and Solution

- Our Solution:

Crave is a digital-first platform designed to connect customers who crave nutritious, affordable food, Crave is a digital-first platform designed to connect customers who crave nutritious, affordable, and fresh homemade meals with talented home chefs, especially housewives, who seek a flexible and dignified source of income. Crave operates as a food discovery, ordering, and delivery platform where chefs can post their daily menus, and customers can browse, choose, and order meals tailored to their preferences. The platform provides logistics, payment processing, and a feedback loop to ensure quality, hygiene, and satisfaction. Crave doesn't just deliver food—it delivers connection. By humanizing the experience of food ordering and enabling real people to cook for real people, Crave introduces empathy, flexibility, and local empowerment into the convenience economy.

- Product/Service Description:

Crave offers a mobile and web application that brings together home chefs and customers in a convenient, user-friendly way. Home chefs can create verified profiles and upload their daily menus in advance, ensuring that customers have access to a wide range of fresh meal options. Customers can browse available meals in their area, filtered by cuisine, price, ratings, and chef profiles, allowing them to make informed choices based on their preferences. Orders are placed a day in advance, giving chefs ample time to plan and prepare the meals. Crave handles the delivery logistics, ensuring that food reaches customers fresh and on time. A review and rating system fosters transparency and trust, creating an opportunity for meaningful chef-customer bonding. Additional features include chef dashboards that provide insights into earnings, orders, and menu management, as well as customer



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dashboards where users can save favorites, track past orders, and manage meal preferences. The platform also includes a flexible leave system, where chefs can opt out on any given day simply by not listing a menu, with no penalties or pressure. For security, Crave integrates a secure payment gateway and operates on a transparent commission model, ensuring a fair and smooth experience for both chefs and customers.

- Unique Selling Proposition (USP):

Crave offers daily personalized menus from a diverse range of home chefs, providing customers with a variety of fresh and nutritious meal options tailored to their preferences. The platform supports a flexible working model, especially for housewives and home chefs, allowing them to work from home while maintaining control over their schedules. With end-to-end transparency, customers can view detailed chef profiles, meal descriptions, and verified customer reviews, ensuring they make informed decisions. Crave takes an empowerment-focused approach, treating chefs not as vendors but as creators, giving them the recognition and flexibility they deserve. The platform emphasizes health, hygiene, and a deep emotional connection with food, prioritizing the well-being of customers while fostering a meaningful experience around every meal.

- Features and Their Benefits:

Crave offers several features designed to enhance both the chef and customer experience. Home chefs upload their daily menus in advance, providing flexibility and allowing both chefs and customers to plan ahead. Each chef has a verified profile, complete with a bio, cuisine details, and customer ratings and reviews, which helps build trust and ensures customers can make informed choices. The pre-order mechanism allows customers to place orders a day in advance, reducing food waste, ensuring timely meal preparation, and eliminating last-minute stress for chefs. Crave handles all delivery logistics, relieving chefs of the delivery hassle and guaranteeing reliability for customers. Chefs also enjoy the flexibility to skip a day by choosing not to list a menu, offering them complete autonomy and promoting a healthy work-life balance. A verified chef onboarding process, including KYC and kitchen verification, ensures food safety and builds the platform's credibility. The platform includes customer reviews and feedback loops, which help with quality control and foster a sense of community trust. Chefs can track their earnings, orders, and reviews through an earnings dashboard, encouraging financial transparency. Additionally, the in-app chat support and help center provide real-time issue resolution, enhancing user satisfaction. Customers can favorite chefs and easily reorder meals, promoting customer retention and repeat business for chefs. Finally, secure payment integration with trusted gateways ensures smooth and safe transactions for all users.

- Innovative Aspects of the Solution:

Crave is more than just a food delivery platform; it's a community-first model that connects passionate cooks with appreciative eaters, fostering a sense of belonging and shared experience. Through its tech-enabled approach, Crave empowers chefs with business-like control, providing them with valuable tools like analytics, order tracking, and customer feedback—all accessible directly on their phones. The platform is built with trust mechanisms in mind, offering transparent reviews and chef visibility, which ensures safer and more reliable experiences for customers. Designed to scale, Crave's model is



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adaptable, allowing it to grow city by city while maintaining a hyper-local and personalized touch. This scalability ensures that as the platform expands, it continues to prioritize community connections. Furthermore, Crave has a significant socioeconomic impact by creating micro-entrepreneurship opportunities, especially for women in underrepresented communities, giving them the chance to build their own businesses from home.

Market Research and Analysis

- **Market and Competitive Landscape:**

India's food delivery market is undergoing a dramatic evolution. According to RedSeer and Statista, the sector was valued at ₹2.9 billion in 2023 and is expected to exceed ₹4.3 billion by 2025, driven by rising urbanization, dual-income households, and digital adoption. However, consumer expectations are shifting. While platforms like Zomato and Swiggy have captured mass markets through convenience, discounts, and partnerships with commercial kitchens, they do not cater to the growing demand for clean, comforting, home-cooked meals.

This gap has been amplified post-pandemic, with rising awareness of food hygiene, immunity-boosting diets, and the emotional comfort of homestyle meals. At the same time, cloud kitchens and fast food are being criticized for their lack of personalization, poor transparency in sourcing, and repetition. Crave enters as a niche but growing player in the under-served segment of authentic, chef-curated homemade meals—offering not only food, but also human connection and trust.

- **Industry Overview (Porter's Five Forces):**

- Threat of New Entrants: Medium**
While the core technology (app and logistics integration) is replicable, Crave's competitive moat lies in its curated chef network, review systems, and operational model focused on flexibility and empowerment. New entrants would need to build trust, manage logistics delicately, and create dual-sided onboarding for both chefs and customers.
- Bargaining Power of Buyers: High**
Customers today are spoiled for choice, with multiple options across Zomato, Swiggy, tiffin providers, and even local WhatsApp meal groups. Crave must focus on delivering superior value: freshness, chef trust, hygiene, and affordability. Consistency and transparent feedback will be essential to build long-term loyalty.
- Bargaining Power of Suppliers (Chefs): Medium**
Home chefs are eager for platforms that allow flexible work and fair income. While Crave is designed to attract them through low entry barriers, its success depends on retaining quality chefs by providing respect, visibility, and income without overburdening them with operational complexity.
- Threat of Substitutes: High**
Substitutes include restaurant meals, cloud kitchens, traditional dabbawala systems, home cooking, and even meal kits. Crave must position itself as the emotional and health-conscious alternative—combining home-cooked authenticity with digital convenience.
- Industry Rivalry: High**
The food tech industry is fiercely competitive, with frequent price wars, ad spends, and



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promotions. However, Crave differentiates itself by focusing exclusively on home chefs, something large players overlook. This niche focus allows Crave to build a loyal, value-driven audience outside the commercial kitchen battle.

- **Market Size, Growth, and Trends:**

The online food delivery market in India saw a significant milestone in 2023, with over 160 million users, and is projected to exceed 200 million by 2025. Among this, the “homemade food” segment alone is valued at ₹450 crore in urban centers and remains largely unstructured, presenting a substantial opportunity for organized platforms like Crave to capitalize on. With rising trends in conscious consumption—such as clean eating, locally sourced ingredients, and food’s role in promoting mental wellness—the demand for healthier, personalized food options is growing. The surge of hyperlocal commerce and gig economy tools is enabling individual creators, including home chefs, to connect directly with consumers, bypassing traditional middlemen. Additionally, increasing internet penetration in Tier-2 cities is expanding the reach of such platforms beyond metro areas, further fueling the demand for convenient, nutritious meal solutions.

- **Target Customer Profile:**

The target audience for Crave primarily falls within the age group of 18 to 50 years, living in Tier-1 and Tier-2 urban cities, starting with Mumbai, Bengaluru, and Delhi NCR. This includes working professionals, students, elderly individuals living independently, bachelors, and new parents, all of whom share a common need for convenient, healthy, and home-style meals. Their lifestyle traits reflect a strong prioritization of health, yet they often lack the time to cook for themselves. Many are emotionally attached to the comfort of “ghar ka khaana” (home-cooked food), making Crave a highly appealing option. Additionally, this demographic is comfortable using mobile apps for everyday tasks such as ordering groceries, cabs, and food, and they are open to supporting local and independent creators over large corporations, valuing authenticity and community-driven experiences.

- **Customer Needs & Behavior:**

For customers, trust and hygiene are the top priorities when making food-related decisions. They prefer platforms that offer clear chef profiles and genuine reviews to ensure both safety and quality. These customers seek daily meal variety without the commitment of long-term tiffin subscriptions, favoring flexibility in their meal choices. Simplicity in the ordering process is essential, and the ability to select meals based on personal preferences is a key differentiator. Many customers are emotionally driven, longing for the comforting flavors of “mom’s cooking” or regional dishes from their hometowns, and they are often willing to pay a premium for food that feels personal and familiar. Additionally, they are open to pre-ordering meals as long as they are assured of consistency and transparency in the quality and delivery of the food.

- **Collaborator Behavior (Chefs/Home Cooks):**

Many home chefs, particularly housewives, are hesitant to enter commercial kitchens but are eager to cook from home with full autonomy. They are looking for platforms that offer flexible working hours, the ability to take leaves without penalties, and transparent payment models. Additionally, they prefer platforms that provide basic digital onboarding and tech support to make the transition into online food services easier. Trust, safety, and privacy are crucial to these chefs, as they prefer to keep their personal details confidential while sharing only food photos and limited information. Most chefs want to focus on what they do best—cooking—rather than dealing with delivery logistics or marketing, which makes Crave’s operational support an attractive feature. This combination of flexibility, autonomy, and



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support positions Crave as a valuable platform for home chefs seeking both independence and convenience.

Competitor	Positioning	Strengths	Weaknesses
Dabbawalas	Hyper-local, low-cost, fixed route	Reliable, low cost	No customization, rigid menus, offline-only
Zomato/Swiggy	On-demand food from restaurants and cloud kitchens	Wide selection, fast delivery, strong branding	Commercialized food, lacks homemade options
Local Tiffins	Monthly subscriptions with limited menu variety	Affordable, homemade food	No flexibility, no ratings, no tech or tracking
WhatsApp/Facebook	Informal chef networks, referrals-based	Personalized, regional cuisine	Unorganized, no payment protection or delivery
Crave	Personalized, chef-curated home meals with delivery & pre-order	Daily variety, chef profiles, chef empowerment	Newer platform; requires scale and community trust

Business Model

Category	Details
Strategic Position	Differentiation – Crave offers personalized, hygienic, and emotionally resonant home-cooked meals prepared by verified home chefs.
Revenue Streams	• Commission from chefs per order (e.g., 10–15%) • Platform fee from customers (₹10–₹20/order) • Premium chef listings • Subscriptions & corporate tie-ups (future)
Pricing Strategy	• Value-based pricing – meals priced by chefs within platform guidelines • Affordable with options for promotions and loyalty programs
Sales Channels	• Mobile app (primary) • Web platform (secondary) • Word-of-mouth via chefs • Community events and digital marketing
Watering Holes	• Instagram – food stories, reels • WhatsApp – meal group sharing • LinkedIn – corporate outreach • Reddit/YouTube – user stories & chef videos
Key Partnerships	• Local delivery providers • NGOs & women support groups • Payment gateways (Razorpay, Paytm) • Hygiene certification agencies
Suppliers (Chefs)	• Housewives and home cooks • Onboarded through KYC, menu upload, and rating system • Provided with autonomy, dashboards, and logistics support



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Customer Acquisition	• Influencer-led campaigns • Chef and customer referral program • Local society activations • SEO & paid ads for “homemade meals,” etc.
Customer Retention	• Reorder & favorite chef options • Personalized notifications • Loyalty points and meal bundles • Push alerts for new chef menus
Differentiators (USP)	• Authentic homemade food • Daily updated menus • Chef flexibility (opt-out days) • Transparent chef profiles & customer ratings

- **Revenue Streams:** Crave leverages a multi-stream revenue model that scales with user base and chef engagement:

- 10% Commission per Meal from Chefs: Each home chef pays a 10% commission on every meal sold. This model ensures that Crave earns with every successful transaction without placing an upfront burden on chefs. It aligns Crave’s success directly with that of its chefs.
- Platform Fee from Customers (₹5–₹10 per Order): Customers are charged a small convenience fee per order, which contributes to operational costs such as payment processing, customer support, and platform upkeep. The low fee maintains affordability while generating volume-based revenue.
- Premium Monetization Options:
 - a) Featured Chef Visibility: Chefs can opt for paid promotions to be highlighted on the homepage or shown at the top of search results.
 - b) Subscription Plans (Future): Monthly or weekly subscription plans for users offering perks like free delivery, discounts, or access to exclusive chefs/meals.

- **Pricing Strategy – Competitive Yet Value-Driven:** Crave follows a competitive pricing model that reflects the quality and effort behind each meal:

- Meal Pricing: Ranges between ₹200–₹400 (excluding delivery charges). The pricing is set by the chefs but within Crave’s guidelines to maintain value consistency.
- Meals are portioned generously and prepared with fresh ingredients in hygienic home kitchens, delivering restaurant-level satisfaction with homemade warmth.
- Periodic discounts, meal bundles, and festival specials will be introduced to keep the experience exciting and price-sensitive customers engaged.

- **Sales Channels**

Crave will implement an omnichannel strategy to effectively reach a broad yet targeted audience across multiple touchpoints. The **mobile app** will serve as the primary platform, offering a seamless experience for



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ordering meals, interacting with chefs, discovering daily menus, and making payments. Designed for ease of use and personalization, it will be the heart of user engagement. Complementing this is the **web platform**, a responsive website that delivers the same features for desktop users and is tailored for corporate clients seeking larger meal solutions.

On the marketing front, **social media channels** like Instagram and WhatsApp will be leveraged to showcase chef stories, highlight daily meals, and share customer testimonials. Engaging content such as interactive stories and food reels will help drive virality and build a community around the brand. In addition to consumer outreach, Crave will pursue **B2B partnerships** with co-living spaces, PG accommodations, college hostels, and startup offices, enabling the platform to offer curated meal plans at scale while tapping into highly relevant, high-demand environments.

- **Watering Holes (Where Customers Gather):**

Understanding where the target audience spends their time is key to Crave's strategic engagement and outreach. **Offices and tech parks** in metro cities present a prime opportunity for lunch meal orders, as working professionals increasingly seek healthy, affordable alternatives to restaurant food. **Hostels and PG accommodations** are home to a large number of students and young professionals who have limited access to home-cooked meals and are often looking for convenient, nutritious options.

Residential societies offer access to a diverse audience that includes middle-income families, senior citizens, and remote workers—all of whom value safe, local, and tasty meals delivered to their doorstep. Beyond physical spaces, **online communities** play a crucial role in influencing food choices. Crave will tap into Facebook food groups, Reddit threads discussing "Ghar ka khana," and Telegram or WhatsApp groups focused on regional cuisines and urban cooking. Engaging with these communities allows Crave to build trust, create awareness, and drive word-of-mouth growth organically among its core audience.

- **Key Partnerships:**

Crave's long-term success relies on establishing a reliable and supportive ecosystem through key strategic partnerships. Collaborations with **local logistics providers** will ensure efficient and timely food delivery, allowing Crave to focus on its core offerings while maintaining a seamless customer experience. To strengthen its social impact and expand its chef network, Crave will partner with **NGOs and women empowerment organizations**, especially in Tier-2 cities. These partnerships will support the onboarding and training of housewives and home chefs, equipping them with the skills and confidence to succeed on the platform.

Additionally, alliances with **FinTech partners** will enable secure and smooth payment processing for both customers and chefs. These financial partnerships may also include features like micro-loans or wallet services, allowing chefs to reinvest in their kitchens—whether it's purchasing fresh ingredients, upgrading equipment, or scaling operations. Together, these alliances will help Crave build a robust, inclusive, and scalable platform that empowers home chefs while delivering consistent value to customers.



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- **Suppliers – Verified Home Chefs:**

Crave's suppliers are the soul of the platform—talented home chefs who operate from their own kitchens, bringing authenticity and warmth to every meal. The platform maintains high standards by implementing a clear **selection criteria**: chefs must undergo a KYC process, pass a basic kitchen hygiene assessment, and successfully complete a trial menu round before being onboarded. This ensures quality, safety, and consistency from the very beginning.

Crave adopts a **local-first approach**, with each chef serving a specific neighborhood or locality. This not only ensures faster, fresher deliveries but also builds a stronger sense of community between chefs and customers. The platform empowers its chefs by offering full **autonomy and support**—they have complete control over their menus, working days, and pricing. In return, Crave provides them with a digital dashboard to manage orders and earnings, end-to-end logistics support, and promotional tools to grow their visibility. This combination of independence and infrastructure helps chefs thrive while delivering a unique, home-cooked experience to every customer.

- **Customer Acquisition Strategy:**

Crave will adopt a mix of digital and on-ground marketing strategies to build a strong and engaged user base right from Day 1. **Influencer marketing** will play a key role, with collaborations involving food bloggers, nutritionists, and lifestyle creators who can authentically share the stories behind Crave meals and the chefs who make them. This not only builds credibility but also highlights the platform's focus on homemade, nutritious food.

To encourage organic growth, **referral codes** will be offered to both chefs and customers, rewarding them for bringing friends and family onto the platform, thereby strengthening the Crave community. New users will be welcomed with **first-time user coupons**, such as free delivery or discounts on their initial order, to reduce entry barriers and boost early conversions.

On-ground, Crave will host **pop-up stalls and sampling events** at local festivals, residential society gatherings, and college campuses. These activations will allow potential users to taste Crave meals, interact with the brand, and download the app instantly—creating a tangible connection and driving immediate engagement.

Marketing and Sales Strategy

- **Brand Name:** Crave

Tagline: "When hunger strikes, start craving"

Crave isn't just a food delivery app; it's a movement toward mindful eating, meaningful entrepreneurship, and emotional nourishment. The platform represents more than just meals—it fosters a deeper connection between people and food, emphasizing the importance of quality, authenticity, and community.



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- **Brand Essence:** Crave stands for authenticity, warmth, and community. Each meal offered through Crave has a face and a story behind it—a chef who poured their care, creativity, and passion into every dish. This personal touch ensures that every bite is more than just nourishment; it's a reflection of a home chef's dedication to providing comfort and care.
- **Messaging Pillars:**
 - **Homemade Comfort:** The meals on Crave evoke the warmth and familiarity of home-cooked food, reminding customers of their mother's kitchen rather than mass-produced meals from factories.
 - **Flexibility & Trust:** Crave gives customers the power to choose when, what, and from whom they want to eat, ensuring full control over their dining experience while building trust through transparency and quality.
 - **Empowerment of Chefs:** Home chefs, especially women, are celebrated as creators—not just service providers. Crave gives them the opportunity to showcase their skills, control their schedules, and build their own businesses with autonomy and support.
- **Marketing Channels:**

Crave will rely on a mix of high-engagement digital content, community marketing, and influencer credibility to grow its user base and reach. Crave will rely on a mix of high-engagement digital content, community marketing, and influencer credibility to grow its user base and reach.

1. Instagram (Primary Driver):

- Short-form reels of chefs cooking regional meals
- "Behind the Plate" series featuring chef stories
- Polls, countdowns, and giveaways to engage users
- Stories showing real customer testimonials and daily menus

2. YouTube (Long-form Trust Building):

- Food vlogs featuring "A Day in the Life of a Crave Chef"
- Recipe videos with emotional storytelling
- Collaborations with regional cooking channels

3. WhatsApp Campaigns (Hyperlocal):

- Meal menus shared in gated society and college groups
- Flash discounts and new chef intros through broadcast lists
- Feedback collection and referral reminders

4. Influencer Endorsements:

- Collaborations with health & wellness influencers who promote clean eating
- Mom bloggers, regional food critics, and dieticians endorsing chef meals
- Celebrity chef testimonials during festival campaigns (e.g., Diwali thalis)

- **Sales Tactics:** Crave's sales model revolves around building immediate value for first-timers and rewarding repeat users.
 - **First Meal Free:** Every new user gets their first meal at zero cost (excluding delivery) to build initial trust and drive adoption.



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- **Chef Loyalty Points:** Customers earn loyalty points when ordering repeatedly from the same chef, which they can redeem for discounts or free items.
- **Referral Program:** Users and chefs are both incentivized for bringing others on board—with ₹50–₹100 credits after successful order completions.
- **Festival Campaigns:** Holi – “Rang Birangi Rasoi” (colorful regional menus by different chefs). Eid – “Ghar ki Biryani” chef specials. Diwali – “Chef ki Diwali Thali” with bundled meal boxes and sweets. Christmas/New Year – Curated “Winter Comfort Box” by selected chefs
- **Customer Retention Strategy:** Crave understands that retention comes not from discounts, but emotional investment and habitual satisfaction.
 - **Personalized Meal Suggestions:** Using order history, dietary tags (e.g., “lactose-free,” “low spice”), and liked cuisines, Crave recommends personalized meals daily.
 - **Favorite Chef Alerts:** Customers get notified when their favorite chef uploads a new menu or returns from a break. This fosters chef-customer bonds.
 - **Milestone Rewards & Achievement Badges:**
Users get digital badges like:
 - “Loyal Taster” – ordering 10 meals from the same chef
 - “Explorer” – trying 5 different cuisines
 - “Top Supporter” – highest rating given consistentlyThese gamified elements encourage re-engagement and community pride.
 - **Limited-Time Exclusives:** Surprise offers like “Chef’s Sunday Special” or “Midweek Treats” keep users curious and coming back.

Operations Plan

This section outlines the core infrastructure, processes, and resources necessary for seamless day-to-day functioning of the platform. The goal is to create a robust ecosystem that supports homemakers in listing meals, enables customers to place orders easily, and ensures reliable delivery through streamlined operations.

- Product Development Requirements:

The backbone of the platform lies in a strong technology foundation. Key development needs include:

- **Cross-Platform App Development:** Android, iOS, and web applications to cater to a diverse user base.
- **Real-Time Menu Updates:** Allow homemakers (chefs) to list next-day menus by 8 PM, as seen in the image under “Menu Listing”.
- **Chef-Side Dashboard:** Enable homemakers to manage dish availability, receive orders, and view analytics.
- **Secure Payment Integration:** Implement reliable and encrypted payment gateways for trust and convenience.



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- **ML-Powered Feedback System:** Use machine learning to analyze order data and optimize meal recommendations, pricing insights, and chef performance.
- **Rating and Review Mechanism:** Transparent customer feedback system to maintain service quality.
- **Logistics & Supply Chain:**
To ensure reliable food delivery without owning fleet infrastructure:
 - **Third-Party Delivery Aggregation:** Partner with local delivery providers.
 - **Dynamic Delivery Allocation:** Orders are routed to the nearest available delivery partner in real-time based on location and timing.
 - **Order Lifecycle Synchronization:** From listing (by 8 PM), to overnight confirmation, to morning meal prep and dispatch, the backend must sync operations (as depicted in the image: Menu Listing → Order Placement → Order Confirmation → Meal Preparation).
- **Physical Assets Required:**
Operational readiness requires basic infrastructure and onboarding assets:
 - **Central Team Workspace:** A physical office for development, marketing, and customer operations teams.
 - **Onboarding Devices for Chefs:** Tablets or smartphones for chefs without compatible devices.
 - **Promotional Material:** Flyers, aprons, QR codes, banners for visibility and trust-building during onboarding drives.
- **Team and Roles:**
To execute and scale operations efficiently, the following team structure is essential:
 - **Tech Team:** Developers and testers focused on app performance, bug fixes, new features, and backend scalability.
 - **Chef Relations Team:** Handles onboarding, training, and continuous support for homemakers.
 - **Marketing Team:** Drives digital and offline campaigns, user acquisition, and brand building.
 - **Operations Team:** Manages real-time logistics, daily execution monitoring, and delivery coordination.
 - **Customer Support Team:** Handles order complaints, payment issues, refunds, and user queries.
- **Milestones and Timeline:**
A phased approach ensures lean validation, iterative improvements, and region-wise scaling:
 - **Month 1–2:**
 - ✓ Build and test Alpha version of the app.
 - ✓ Initiate internal testing with a small group of homemakers.
 - ✓ Finalize onboarding processes and support documentation.
 - **Month 3–4:**
 - ✓ Launch pilot in Mumbai with a target of 50 homemakers.
 - ✓ Collect initial customer feedback, iterate on app features.
 - ✓ Begin partnerships with third-party delivery partners.
 - **Month 5–6:**
 - ✓ Expand operations to Pune and Bangalore.
 - ✓ Roll out the machine learning-based recommendation and feedback engine.
 - ✓ Scale marketing efforts and refine logistics algorithm based on early learnings.



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Risk Analysis and Contingency Plan:

Launching a new platform involves inherent risks across business operations, finance, and market adoption. This section identifies key risks and outlines strategic mitigation measures to ensure business resilience and continuity.

- **Business Risk: Low Chef Availability**

Risk Explanation: The core of the platform depends on the availability and reliability of home chefs. If there is an insufficient number of active chefs or inconsistent participation (e.g., skipping days, low menu updates), it could result in poor customer experience, fewer food options, and ultimately reduced order volume.

Contingency Plan:

- Financial Incentives for Consistency: Introduce bonuses or higher commission rates for homemakers who maintain regular listing schedules and meet a minimum threshold of weekly orders.
- Zero-Penalty Opt-Out Model: Allow homemakers to skip days without penalties, reducing pressure and promoting voluntary participation. This flexibility makes the platform more appealing and sustainable for part-time homemakers.
- Chef Onboarding Pipeline: Continuously onboard new chefs to ensure supply redundancy, especially during peak seasons or festivals.
- Chef Community Engagement: Create community forums and local meetups to foster motivation, skill-sharing, and a sense of belonging.

- **Financial Risk: Slower User Adoption and Revenue Growth**

Risk Explanation: There is a risk that customer adoption may not scale as quickly as forecasted, leading to lower-than-expected revenues. This could impact cash flow, ROI timelines, and marketing ROI.

Contingency Plan:

- Staggered Marketing Rollout: Instead of an all-at-once marketing push, employ a city-wise phased approach. Allocate budget dynamically based on response from each region.
- Lean Cost Structure: Minimize fixed operational costs—such as by working in co-working spaces, leveraging third-party logistics, and adopting a freelance model for customer support during early stages.
- Investor and Grant Buffer: Maintain a financial buffer for the first 12–18 months to withstand early-stage volatility, and explore grants or startup funds focused on women's empowerment and food-tech innovation.
- Early Monetization Tactics: Introduce premium subscription options, custom meal plans, or loyalty-based upselling to drive early revenue.

- **Market Risk: Customer Churn and Retention Issues**



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Risk Explanation: In a competitive food-tech space, customers may try the service once but not return due to inconsistent quality, limited options, or better alternatives. High customer churn can erode CAC (Customer Acquisition Cost) efficiency and limit word-of-mouth growth.

Contingency Plan:

- Personalized Offers and Loyalty Programs: Use machine learning to deliver targeted offers based on customer preferences, order history, and meal ratings. Reward frequent users with cashback, discounts, or free delivery.
- Chef-Subscription Model: Allow customers to subscribe to a favorite chef's weekly or monthly menu, enabling predictable sales for chefs and routine meal planning for customers.
- Feedback-Driven Improvements: Actively analyze customer reviews and complaints to identify patterns and improve both app features and meal quality.
- Satisfaction Guarantee: Offer refunds or credits for unsatisfactory meals to build trust and encourage repeated usage.

Financial Plan

- Startup Costs:

- App & Web Development: **₹1,50,000**
- Marketing: **₹50,000**
- Logistics Contracts + Setup: **₹30,000**
- **Total: ₹2,30,000**

- Funding Requirements:

- Seed Round: ₹3.5 Lakhs

- Use of Funds:

- **65%** – Product & Operations
- **25%** – Marketing
- **10%** – Contingency

(Aligned with the image breakdown: Technology & Ops 50%, Marketing 30%, User Acquisition 20% — showing refinement in later budgeting)

- Revenue Projections:

- **Year 1:**
 - Avg. 500 orders/day
 - Revenue: ~₹1.1 Crore annually
- **Year 2:**



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- Scaling to 1,500 orders/day
- Revenue: ₹3 Crores+

- **Break-even Analysis:**

- Break-even achievable by **Month 12** with **1,000 daily orders**

- **Call to Action:**

Invest in Crave – the home-cooked revolution is just heating up!

Conclusion

- **Summary:** Crave is more than a food delivery platform — it's a community-driven ecosystem that connects people through the universal love for home-cooked meals. By empowering home chefs with flexible earning opportunities and offering customers wholesome, authentic food from real kitchens, Crave addresses both livelihood and lifestyle needs.
- **Call to Action:** We're calling on visionary partners, passionate chefs, and curious early adopters to be part of our pilot phase. Together, we can build a more inclusive, healthier, and heartwarming food experience.
- **Long-Term Vision**

Our roadmap includes:

- Pan-India Expansion
- Regional Cuisine Curation
- Subscription-Based Meal Plans
- Verified Chef Certification Programs

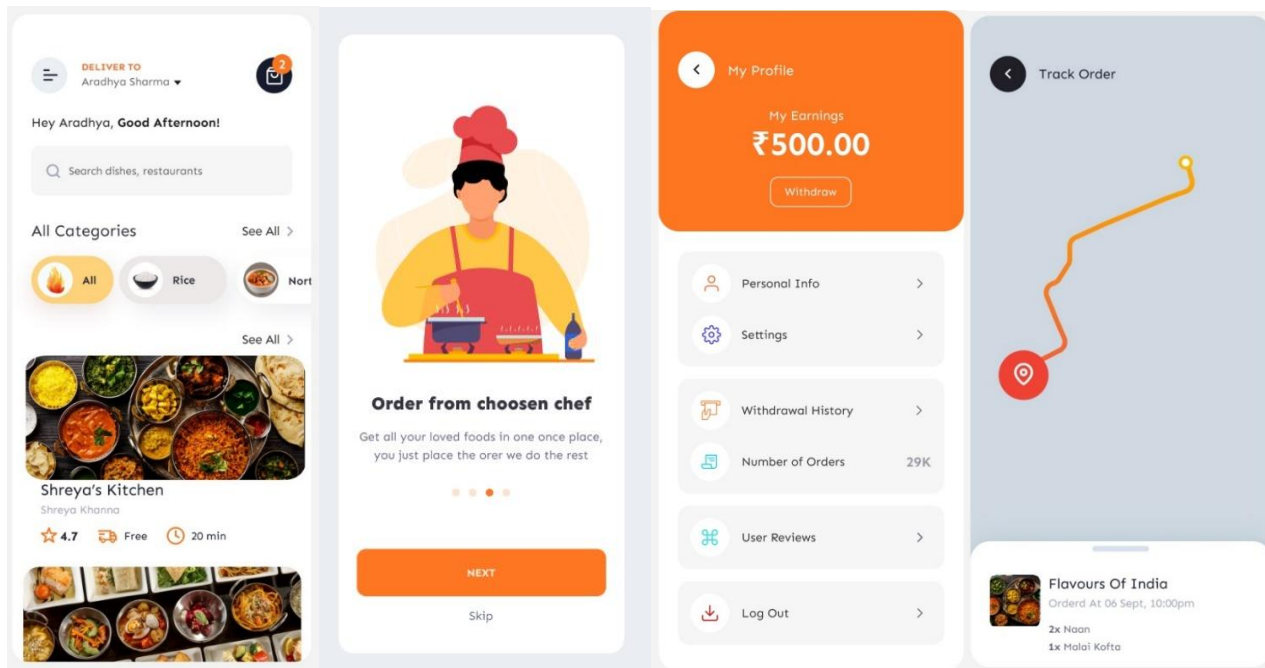
These initiatives will help Crave scale sustainably while maintaining quality, trust, and regional diversity.

Final Remarks: Crave is where **passion meets plates** — uplifting home cooks and delighting customers, one meal at a time. Join us in redefining food delivery with heart, heritage, and homemade goodness.

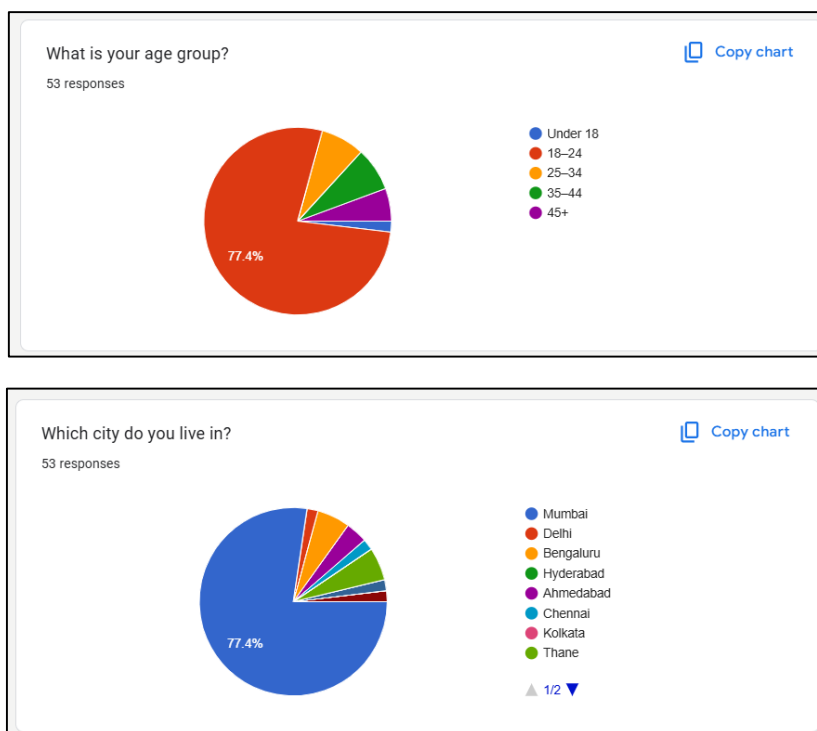
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Appendices

- Wireframes or App Screenshots:

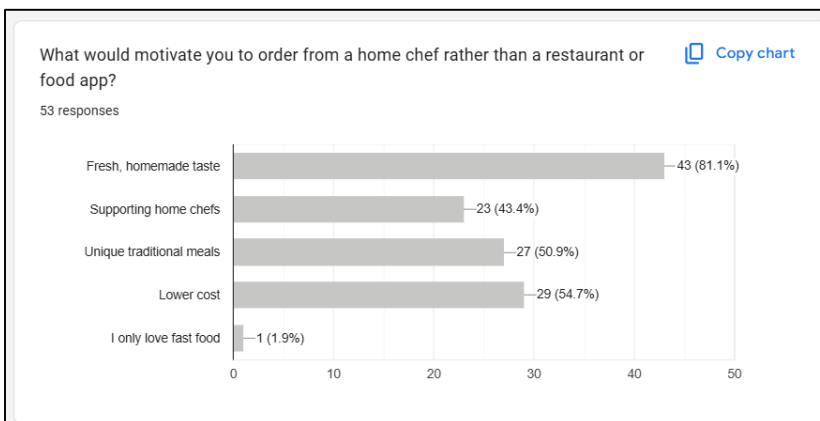
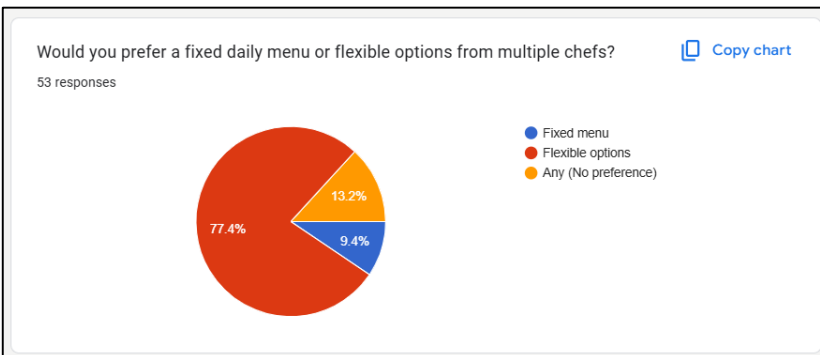
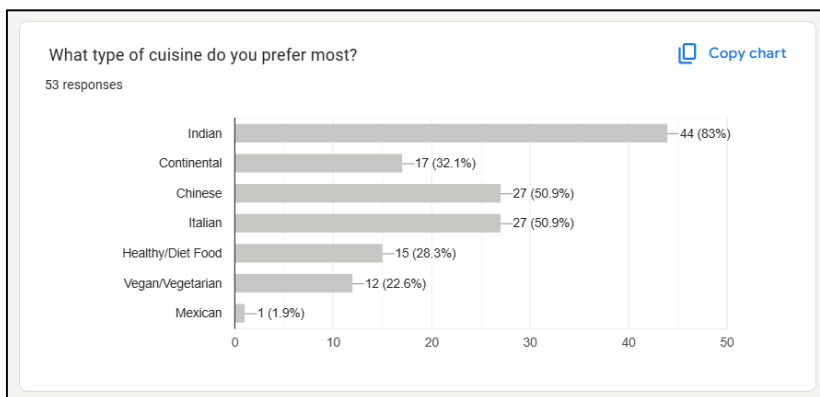
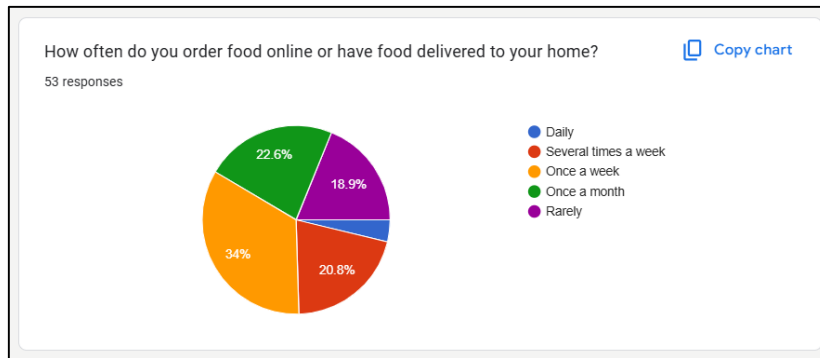


- Market Survey & Analysis:



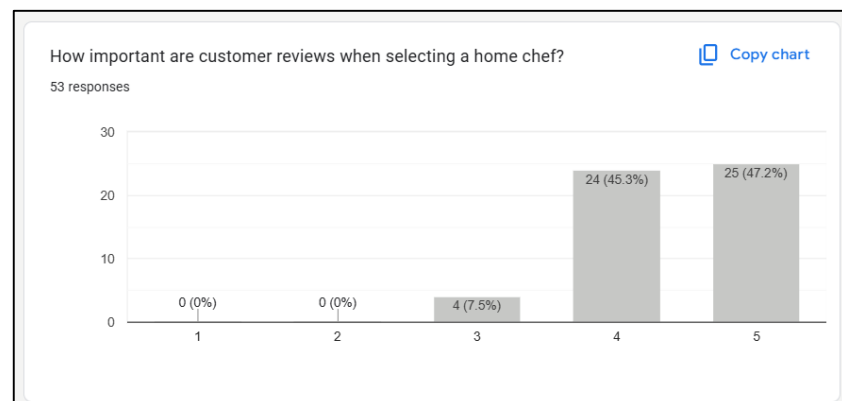
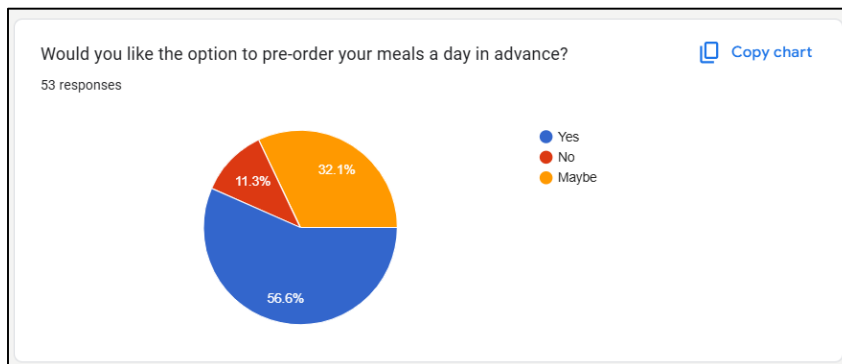
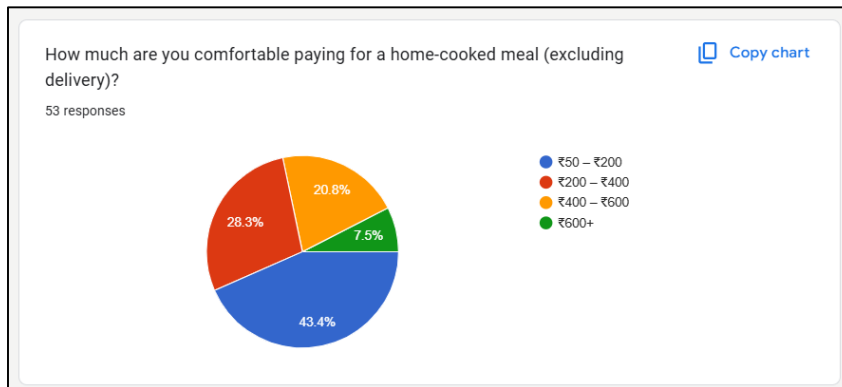
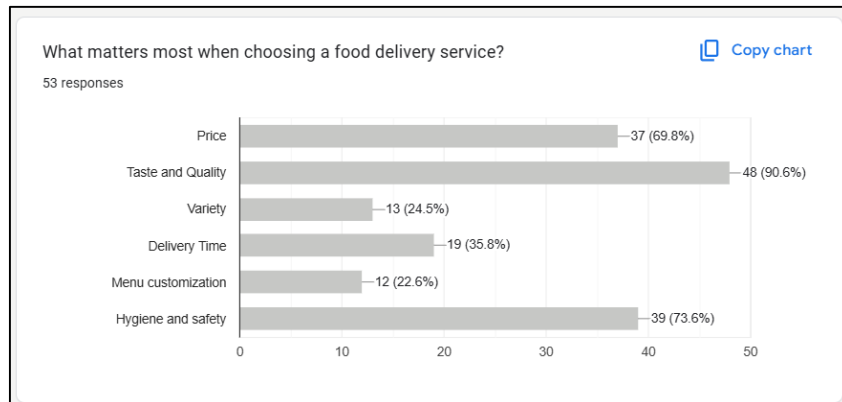


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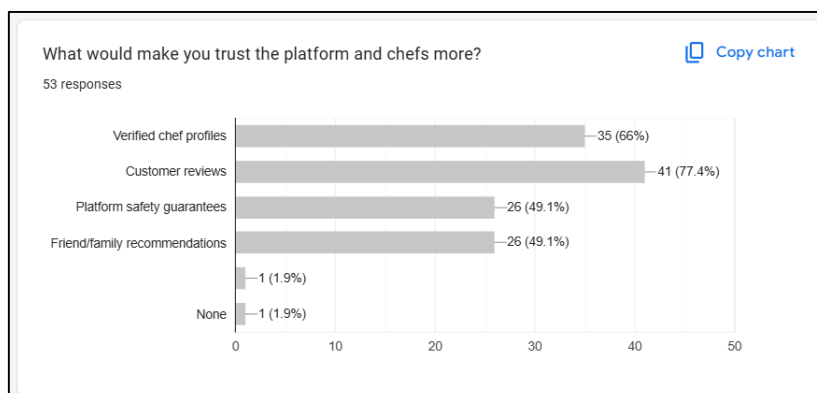
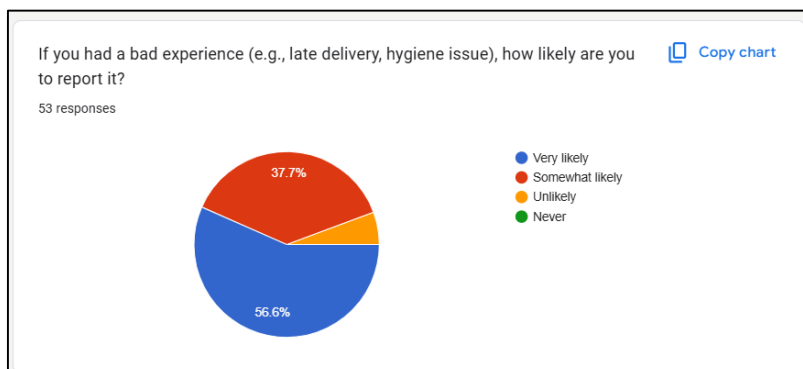
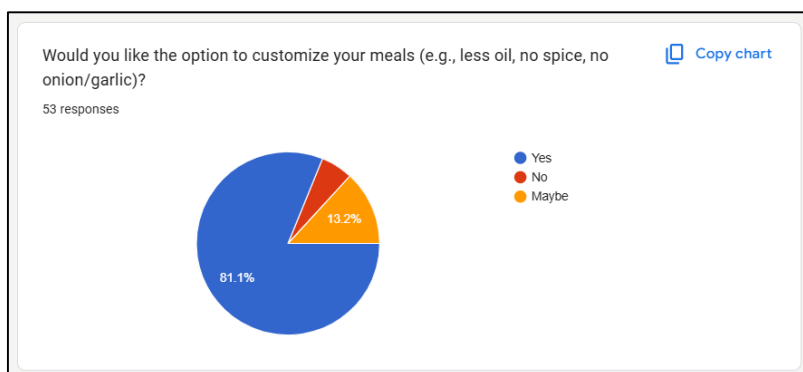
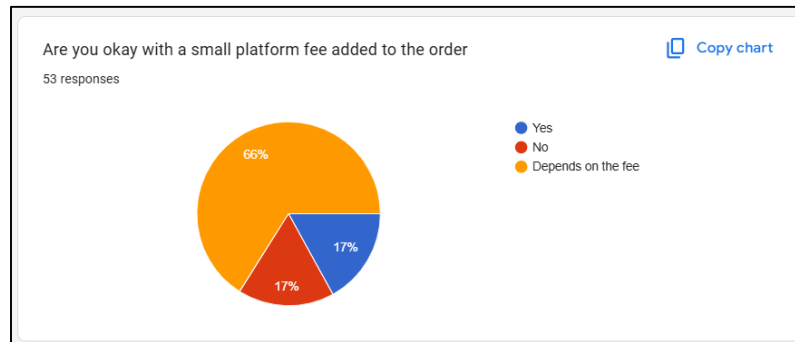


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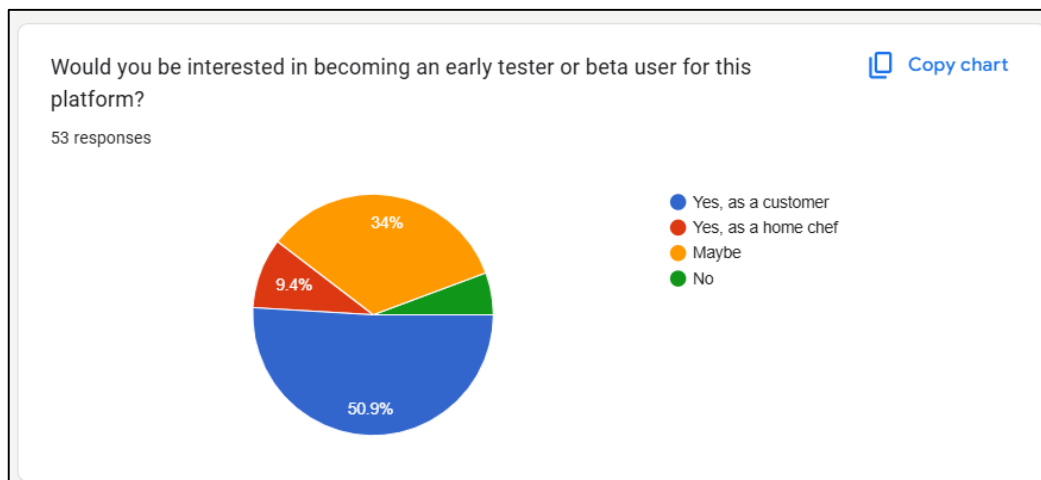


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Do you have any feedback, feature suggestions, or concerns you'd like us to consider?

53 responses

- Very good
- Looking forward to using this platform.
- Hire chefs from different state to incorporate regional cuisines and tastes
- Verification is very important.
- Maybe add a meni which lets user choose the type of containers in which the food shall be delivered since many refrain from using plastic containers while the alternative may seem expensive to others
- Idk
- Keep it customised but with more indian options
- nope
- How will a particular state home chef will know the home cooked meal styles of other states

Webliography

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- <https://zomato.com>
- <https://investindia.gov.in>
- <https://redseer.com>
- <https://statista.com>